

# ANDREW MERRITT

Louisville, KY • [a0merr05@louisville.edu](mailto:a0merr05@louisville.edu) • [github.com/a0merr](https://github.com/a0merr) • [Linked In](#)

Computer Science student (3.62 GPA, graduating December 2027) who builds quantitative infrastructure and autonomous AI agents in Python, Java, and C++. Ships independent projects end to end — an event-driven backtesting framework with a 126× vectorization speedup, a self-directed ML research agent, a Spring Boot/PostgreSQL trade journal — and contributes CI supply-chain hardening to SigmaHQ, the open standard for detection engineering.

Seeking a **Summer 2027** software engineering internship — available full-time from **January 2028**.

## EDUCATION

### University of Louisville — J.B. Speed School of Engineering

*Expected December 2027*

*B.A. in Computer Science • GPA 3.62 / 4.0 • 84 credit hours completed • Louisville, KY*

- Fall 2026 coursework: Design of Operating Systems, Introduction to Algorithms. Prior: Technical Certificate, Indiana College Core — Ivy Tech Community College (GPA 3.6, 2020–2024).

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Languages** Python, C++, C, Java, C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL (expanding: Rust)

**AI / ML** PyTorch, NumPy, Pandas, Anthropic API, LLM agent orchestration and tool-use design

**Systems** Spring Boot, PostgreSQL, React, Node.js, REST API design, Docker, GitHub Actions CI/CD, Testcontainers, Linux

## PROJECTS

### axiom-backtest — Event-Driven Backtesting Framework

*Python • [github.com/a0merr/axiom-backtest](https://github.com/a0merr/axiom-backtest)*

- Built an event-driven backtester modeling frictions most backtests omit — per-share commission with order minimums, daily short-borrow accrual, margin interest — plus ruin detection and gross leverage caps.
- Implemented four slippage models ranked by realism (fixed, volatility-aware, square-root volume impact, order-book depth-aware), where execution cost at 50% of bar volume spans 5bp to 3,846bp under liquidity stress.
- Replaced per-bar pandas lookups with vectorized alignment: 864,332 rows/sec against 6,877, a 126× speedup processing a 10M-row dataset in ~8.5s at ~1.1GB.
- Case study under rolling-origin walk-forward validation (50/200 MA crossover, SPY/QQQ/EFA/TLT/GLD, 2010–2024): Sharpe 0.78, 95% CI [0.30, 1.27], OOS mean 0.81 across 10 folds — and reported that it underperforms buy-and-hold SPY at 0.84. Built to falsify strategies, not flatter them.

### auto-research-slm / autolab — Autonomous ML Research Loop

*Python • PyTorch • Anthropic API*

- Built an autonomous research agent that trains a small GPT, reads each run's loss and validation metrics, rewrites its own hyperparameters across a seven-dimension search space, and re-runs — 20 experiments per unattended overnight cycle.
- Designed the agent's tool interface and state handling so a malformed or out-of-range run result cannot corrupt the next training configuration — guardrails on an agent holding write access to its own experiment config.
- Streamed live loss curves, experiment history, and the agent's stated reasoning for every change to a browser dashboard, making each decision auditable. Companion build (autolab) runs end to end with no API key or GPU, so reviewers can reproduce it locally.

### tradejournal — Full-Stack Trade Journal

*Java • Spring Boot • PostgreSQL • React*

- Ingests trading-bot fills into PostgreSQL through a Spring Boot REST API, with JWT authentication and Testcontainers-backed integration tests running against a real database rather than mocks.

### Terminal Arcade

*Python • Standard Library Only*

- Rebuilt Snake and Tetris on a custom ANSI rendering engine with threaded input; Tetris ships a 7-bag randomizer, ghost piece, hard drop, and next-piece preview. Cross-platform, zero external dependencies.

**Additional** python-baseline — production-ready template (tests, CI, Docker, pre-commit) • ASList<T> generic sorted container (C++ templates) • IDD Programming Challenge 2026 (TypeScript, CI)

## OPEN SOURCE

### SigmaHQ / sigma — Pull Request #6080

*Under Review*

- Hardened the CI supply chain of the open detection-rule standard (4,000+ rules used across SIEM platforms) by pinning test and validation dependencies into dedicated requirements files, so an upstream release can no longer break contributor pull requests.
- Added pip caching across the GitHub Actions workflows, eliminating redundant package downloads per run. Validated on Python 3.14: full suite passing, sigma check clean, zero detection rules modified.

## EXPERIENCE

### Crew Member — Caesars Southern Indiana • Elizabeth, IN

*Aug 2026 – Present*

- Guest service in the high-volume Piazza dining venue; point-of-sale and food-safety standards.

### Research Intern — University of Louisville

*May 2026 – Aug 2026*

*Aqlan Lab Internship Program • Ohio River Way, "Paddle the Ohio" water-trail initiative • Louisville, KY*

- Ran field ground-truthing audits of public access points across 73 miles of the Ohio River Corridor (Milton to West Point, KY), logging launch conditions, hazards, and amenities into a shared tracker, and shipped an interactive verified-improvements map (ohio-river-way-map).
- Built a stakeholder contact database and live dashboard coordinating outreach across partner organizations, municipalities, and community groups along the river corridor.
- Translated technical audit findings into a reusable outreach campaign pack and a 48×36 conference poster for non-technical stakeholders, converting community needs into actionable plans.

### Crew Member — Taco Bell • Floyds Knobs, IN

*Aug 2021 – Aug 2026*

- Entrusted with opening and closing responsibilities and peak-hour throughput across five years, alongside a full Speed School engineering course load.

## HONORS & CERTIFICATIONS

- First Year Leadership Program (top 10%) • Dean's List: Fall 2024, Fall 2025, Spring 2026 • Anthropic (17 certifications) and Google Cloud (3 badges), Jun 2026